

1600 TOKUGAWA VICTORY AT SEKIGAHARA

The death of Japan's ruler Toyotomi Hideyoshi in 1598 gave the ambitious Tokugawa Ieyasu a chance to bid for power. He was resisted by regents acting in the name of Hideyoshi's five-year-old son. At the battle of Sekigahara the regents were betrayed by key allies and the Tokugawa forces triumphed. Proclaimed shogun in 1603, Ieyasu founded a regime that was to last for over 250 years.



▷ Battle of Sekigahara, Japanese screen

1600

c. 1600 The Dahomey kingdom is founded by the Fon people in West Africa

1600 Peruvian volcano Huaynaputina erupts, with large-scale effects on global weather

1603 Safavid Persian ruler Shah Abbas I launches a successful war against the Ottomans

1600-1602 EAST INDIA COMPANIES COMPETE

Control of the profitable trade in spices and other luxury goods from the East Indies (India and southeast Asia) was fiercely contested between European maritime nations. In 1600, the English crown authorized a group of merchants to form an East India Company with a monopoly of Asian trade. Two years later, England's commercial rivals, the Dutch, established their own East India Company. Highly competitive and aggressive, these companies acquired armed forces and became major agents of their countries' imperial expansion, governing territories in Asia.



△ Officers of the British East India Company in India



◁ Arms of the Dutch East India Company and town of Batavia